



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cambridge School of Dallas
School Website: <https://cambridgedallas.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Austin Classical School (Austin, TX)

Website used: <https://austinclassical.org>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Austin Classical School (ACS) explicitly frames its mission as "to glorify Jesus Christ...[by] cultivat[ing] wise, virtuous, and humble students through an excellent classical, Christian education," and consistently grounds its model in truth, goodness, beauty, the Trivium, Latin, logic, rhetoric, and the Great Tradition. The site demonstrates robust theological integration (Christian Studies sequence including Doctrine, Exegesis/Hermeneutics, Apologetics & Ethics), memory-intensive pedagogy (memorization, recitation, songs), dialectical practices (debate, discussion), and rhetorical culminating work (thesis defense). Parent partnership is explicit ("co-laboring with families") and the school encourages parent education with reading lists and information sessions. Evidence for a formal "portrait of a teacher" or faculty-as-living curriculum is thinner than other areas but still directionally aligned. On balance, ACS meets the classical benchmark across nearly all elements, with strongest evidence in Religious Foundations, Purpose, Curriculum, and Pedagogy.

Element-by-Element Evaluation (with Mandatory Keyword Analysis)

Scoring key: - Rating: CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL - percent_positive: share of found keywords aligning to classical indicators - percent_coverage: breadth of sub-criteria evidenced within the category - pos_neg_hits: +X/-Y = positive classical keyword hits vs negative signals

The positive/negative keyword framework is drawn from "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School" and the supporting lexicon; these define reference signals such as truth, goodness, beauty, virtue; theology; Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books; Socratic/dialectic; memory/recitation; and parent partnership, as well as negatives like values-neutrality, 21st-century skills/college-and-career marketing, project-based dominance, etc.

1) Religious and Metaphysical Foundations

- Keyword evidence (school site):
 - "glorify Jesus Christ...wise, virtuous, and humble...classical, Christian education" (mission)
 - Truth, Goodness, Beauty (stated as aim/method)
 - Christian Studies: Development of Christian Doctrine & Church History, Exegesis & Hermeneutics, Applied Exegesis & Church History, Apologetics & Ethics; explicit "God"/"made in God's image," "theological principles" references in pedagogy text

- Mapping to Six Elements lexicon:
 - Positive: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue, wisdom; theology, biblical studies, doctrine; apologetics; Christian formation.
 - Negative: none observed (no “values□neutral,” “secular/nonsectarian” claims).
- Quantitative estimate:
 - pos_neg_hits: +12/-0
 - percent_positive: 100
 - percent_coverage: 67 (clear evidence of transcendental moral realism and theological integration; liturgical/corporate worship practices are not explicit)
- Rating: CLASSICAL

2) School Purpose and Goal

- Keyword evidence (school site):
 - “cultivate wisdom and virtue” (aim) and T/G/B as method and ends; “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation...more about learning to think and live with an eternal purpose”
- Mapping to Six Elements lexicon:
 - Positive: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation over information.
 - Negative: no “college-and-career readiness/21st-century skills” emphasis.
- Quantitative estimate:
 - pos_neg_hits: +10/-0
 - percent_positive: 100
 - percent_coverage: 100 (all three sub-criteria present)
- Rating: CLASSICAL

3) School Curriculum

- Keyword evidence (school site):
 - Trivium: Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric (staged K–12)
 - Latin begins in 5th grade; formal Logic (8th) and Rhetoric (10th)
 - Great works of the Western tradition; recommended classical reading list; Bible integrated across grades; History named and sequenced (not “social studies”)
 - Integrated/harmony of subjects emphasized: “interrelatedness of all knowledge” under God’s sovereignty
- Mapping to Six Elements lexicon:
 - Positive: Trivium, Latin, Great Books/primary texts, integrated curriculum, history across eras.
 - Negative: no “social studies” substitution; no “project□based learning dominance.”
- Quantitative estimate:
 - pos_neg_hits: +12/-0
 - percent_positive: 100
 - percent_coverage: 90 (Trivium/Latin/Great Books/integration fully present; Quadrivium terms not named explicitly though math/science sequences appear)
- Rating: CLASSICAL

4) School Pedagogy (Teaching Methods)

- Keyword evidence (school site):
 - Lower school: “memorization, recitation, and songs” (memory work)

- Logic years: “debate and discussion” (dialectic)
- Rhetoric years: “begins producing and defending his/her own ideas...Thesis defense and eloquent written and oral communication” (rhetorical training)
- Memory is intentionally trained; “repeated practice” noted
- Mapping to Six Elements lexicon:
 - Positive: recitation/memorization/chant; dialectic/debate/discussion; rhetoric/orations/thesis work. (Note: the term “Socratic” is not used explicitly, but dialectical discussion and debate are present.)
 - Negative: no “experiential/project-based dominance” claims.
- Quantitative estimate:
 - pos_neg_hits: +8/-0
 - percent_positive: 100
 - percent_coverage: 75 (strong memory and dialectic/rhetoric; no explicit references to “scholé/restful” learning terminology)
- Rating: CLASSICAL

5) Faculty

- Keyword evidence (school site):
 - Faculty page emphasizes a Head of School who “loves Jesus” and teachers who serve God “using the classical approach” (directional alignment with model teachers, though few explicit “portrait of a teacher”/“faculty of friends” terms are published)
- Mapping to Six Elements lexicon:
 - Positive: teachers as models of virtue/mentors is implied by Christian framing and classical approach, but lexicon-specific phrases (portrait of a teacher, living curriculum, collegial culture) are not surfaced on the public pages we saw.
 - Negative: none (no “facilitator/guide-on-the-side” jargon).
- Quantitative estimate:
 - pos_neg_hits: +2/-0
 - percent_positive: 100
 - percent_coverage: 33 (limited explicit faculty formation language)
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

6) Parents and Community

- Keyword evidence (school site):
 - “co-laboring with families” (explicit parent partnership)
 - Reading list and “Classical Education Basics” resources for families (parent formation)
 - Open invitations to campus tours/preview nights (welcoming, hospitable culture)
- Mapping to Six Elements lexicon:
 - Positive: partnership with parents; parent formation via recommended readings; intentional community signals.
 - Negative: none (no “parent as customer” language).
- Quantitative estimate:
 - pos_neg_hits: +3/-0
 - percent_positive: 100
 - percent_coverage: 67 (clear on partnership and formation; “parents welcome anytime” not explicitly stated)
- Rating: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Rating

- Overall: CLASSICAL
 - Rationale: Five categories meet classical criteria; one (Faculty) is somewhat classical due to lighter public articulation of faculty formation language. The school's theological grounding, philosophical aim (wisdom/virtue; T/G/B), liberal arts curriculum (Trivium, Latin, Great Books), and pedagogy (memory/-dialectic/rhetoric) are strong and explicit, aligning closely with the Six Elements keyword indicators.
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Evidence Appendix (select, from ACS site)

- Mission and parent partnership: "glorify Jesus Christ...co-laboring with families...classical, Christian education."
- Classical Education Basics: aim/method/tools centered on Truth, Goodness, Beauty; Trivium; Great Books; integrated curriculum.
- Trivium staging and methods (memorization, recitation, songs; debate/discussion; rhetoric/thesis):
- Curriculum staples: Latin from grade 5; logic and rhetoric sequences; great works of the Western tradition; Bible/Christian Studies.
- Theology integrated and named (Doctrine, Exegesis/Hermeneutics, Apologetics & Ethics).

Reference lexicon for scoring (Six Essential Elements + Classicality Lexicon):

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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